

2c. Core Content of A Level in Art and Design

The following core content outlines the scope, context, approaches, skills and knowledge and understanding which underpin all the endorsed Art and Design

titles (specialisms) within the suite of qualifications. This needs to be used in conjunction with the content provided for each specialism.

Scope and Context:	• Learners must engage in integrated critical, practical and theoretical study in Art and Design. • Learners must demonstrate an ability to work within relevant frameworks and use a broad range of media. They must develop independence in relation to exploring their own ideas and lines of enquiry, refining intentions and producing personal outcomes. • Understanding context is a significant element in the process of building knowledge of the subject. It provides the relevant platform to help explore and understand ideas, feelings and meanings. • Learners should demonstrate an understanding of the context through critical evaluation in relation to research, written analysis and practical work. Contextual referencing should be evidenced through evaluation of historical and contemporary practitioners, creative industries, societies and cultures, popular culture, historical and current events. • Learners' critical and contextual understanding will be evidenced throughout all processes and outcomes. The form of critical and contextual understanding may be directed by the approach to media used in the specialism(s) taken but not exclusively so. • Learners must demonstrate, where applicable, an awareness of different roles, functions, audiences and consumers of art, craft and design. • The related study element must extend learners' understanding and knowledge of context. Learners are required to establish, through this written and illustrated element, the overarching principles of their specialist area. This may be established by exploring art theory, genre, subject matter, movement or historical framework. • Through the course of study learners must understand the importance of the on-going development and refining process. The production of outcome(s) in the context of developing their skills and knowledge, as well as an awareness of the links between practical and written material, is necessary. • Learners are required to identify and acknowledge all sources consulted during their research which should be in the form of a bibliography of books, journals and websites.
Approaches:	• Learners should be made aware of the broad range of media and approaches in which they can operate. • Learners may work in traditional media, digital media and emerging technologies or a combination within any specialism. • Critical and contextual understanding should be embedded throughout the course of study through all investigative processes, research and practical work. Learners should reflect critically and extract meaning from art, craft and design and use this to place their own work in a framework of advanced study. Approaches to critical and contextual understanding can be modified, either as a link and support to practical work, or research into the overarching context of art, craft and design. • Learners may use a range of approaches to demonstrate progression of

	ideas relevant to their chosen specialism: these may include sketchbooks, workbooks, journals, digital and audio presentations and associated software. • Learners may take an applied approach to any specialism, working to a brief and framework whilst developing an awareness of the approaches and activities that relate to the creative industries. An applied approach should reflect the current working practices, constraints, functions, audiences, consumers and clients within the professional art and design sector. • Approaches to drawing may be different across specialisms. For example, in Fine Art, observational drawing using traditional media may be employed, whereas in textiles, stitch and fashion illustrations are commonly used.
Core Skills:	Learners are required to develop the skills to: • record experiences and observations, in a variety of ways using drawing or other appropriate visual forms; undertake research and gather, select and organise visual and other appropriate information • explore relevant resources; analyse, discuss and evaluate images, objects and artefacts; and make and record independent judgements • use knowledge and understanding of the work of others to develop and extend thinking and inform own work • generate and explore potential lines of enquiry using appropriate media and techniques • apply knowledge and understanding in making images and artefacts; review and modify work: plan and develop ideas in the light of their own and others' evaluations • organise, select and communicate ideas, solutions and responses, and present them in a range of visual and written forms.
Core Knowledge and Understanding:	Learners are required to develop practical and theoretical knowledge and understanding of: • relevant materials, processes, technologies and resources • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural contexts • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology.